

Chapter 105 - Welcome Back Banquet

Half a month later, with her body completely fine, Feng Yue was allowed to go home to recuperate. After staying in the hospital for over half a month, she felt restless all over and urgently needed to breathe some fresh air.

Jiang Yu and Feng He Hai went to handle her discharge procedures, leaving only her and Yan Lin in the hospital room.

Speaking of her relationship with Yan Lin now, it could be described as inseparable.

Since Feng Yue woke up, Yan Lin continued to monopolize the nighttime bedside vigil rights. This time, her reason to Jiang Yu was that if Feng Yue needed to get up at night, Jiang Yu might not be able to take good care of her.

The elders were all quite speechless about this. Even if Jiang Yu couldn't take care of her alone, they could still hire a caregiver.

But in the end, they didn't voice this thought out of consideration for Feng Yue.

Feng Yue held a tacit approval attitude toward Yan Lin staying overnight at the hospital. Mainly, she still felt sorry for Jiang Yu, as she had become quite haggard during the months of Feng Yue's coma.

Also, after observing Yan Lin for a few days, she discovered that Yan Lin now seemed to have a stress reaction to her sleeping. Whenever she slept a bit longer, Yan Lin would become very anxious and nervous.

Feng Yue also wanted to use this subsequent recovery time to help calm Yan Lin's condition.

Thus, Yan Lin successfully obtained these half-month bedside vigil rights.

Feng Yue's legs still lacked strength, so she could only sit in a wheelchair for now. She was currently sitting in the wheelchair directing Yan Lin to pack her things.

"Put this in that box from earlier."

"You can throw away what's in your left hand - it doesn't seem useful anymore."

"Yes, yes, just leave it like that."

Feng Yue had never enjoyed this kind of service from Yan Lin before, so she had to properly experience this meticulous care.

However, Feng Yue didn't torture her too much. After Yan Lin finished packing for her, she was clever enough to offer a carrot after the stick¹.

"Thank you for your hard work. I'll treat you to a meal later."

But hearing this, Yan Lin wasn't very happy. She didn't like Feng Yue being so formal with her - the way things had been just now was perfect.

But she didn't refuse Feng Yue's kind gesture and obediently nodded.

Today was Feng Yue's discharge day, and quite a few relatives and friends came. Lady Jiang Yu was planning to go directly to a hotel for a small welcome-back banquet to celebrate and ward off bad luck for Feng Yue.

So many people came to the hospital to pick up Feng Yue that morning. Her three aunts' families, several of her friends, and even Yan Lin's parents all came.

Everyone picked up Feng Yue from the hospital together before heading to the hotel.

Wen Zhen came with Zhou Qiong Qiong, followed by Qian He and Xu Yan. These four had all ordered flowers for her, so Feng Yue, sitting in her wheelchair, had to hold a bouquet in each hand.

What surprised Feng Yue most was that even Fu Si Xue, who was currently abroad, had ordered a bouquet through a delivery app to be sent over.

Throughout this flower-receiving process, Yan Lin quietly stayed behind Feng Yue, diligently pushing her wheelchair, looking very considerate.

Wen Zhen looked at the atmosphere between these two and knew she had absolutely no chance anymore. This atmosphere was something she couldn't even break into.

Although it was called a welcome-back banquet, there were only about a dozen people in total. But precisely because of this, everyone ate very happily.

Especially Feng He Hai, who drank until his old face was red, hugged Feng Yue and cried heartbrokenly, crying while muttering things like "my poor daughter."

At first, Feng Yue found her father's situation somewhat funny and helpless, but Feng He Hai cried so genuinely that in the end, Feng Yue's voice also carried a crying tone.

At this point, Jiang Yu couldn't bear to watch anymore. Today was supposed to be a lively and cheerful welcome-back banquet - crying wasn't appropriate.

Only then did Feng Yue escape from her loving father's embrace.

Then Yan Lin took wet tissues and crouched in front of Feng Yue, carefully and seriously wiping away her tears.

However, this emotional state had been triggered by her father, and no matter what, the tears wouldn't stop.

Yan Lin had no choice but to push Feng Yue out of the banquet hall to get some fresh air and clear her head.

Yan Lin pushed her to a small garden separated from the banquet hall by a corridor, where Feng Yue's sobs could still be heard from time to time.

Feng Yue had been awake for so long, yet she still hadn't asked Yan Lin about what happened during her unconscious period. So partly out of curiosity and partly to distract herself, Feng Yue said, "Yan Lin, did anything special happen during the months I was unconscious?"

Yan Lin pushed her to beside a bench and sat down on the bench herself. She wasn't clear on Feng Yue's definition of "special," so she could only roughly describe the living conditions of Feng Yue's parents during those months.

After listening, Feng Yue fell silent again. Although she knew her coma would cause great harm to her family, after learning these specific details, Feng Yue still felt very guilty.

Knowing she felt bad, Yan Lin also actively asked, "What about you? Did you go to that place again while unconscious?"

Feng Yue knew Yan Lin was referring to that space with the book. Being asked this by Yan Lin, Feng Yue described everything she had seen in that space to Yan Lin.

"At the time, I didn't understand what the display about 'protagonist consciousness awakening' meant, but thinking about it now, that protagonist probably refers to you."

Feng Yue raised her head to gaze at the vast, boundless sky. "You awakened the world's consciousness and expelled that so-called controller of the space."

"You saved me." Feng Yue turned her head to look at Yan Lin, those eyes shining brightly even in the dark night.

"But there's another strange thing. I was supposed to be eliminated as an intruder, but at the last moment, a force suddenly pulled me away. Not only that, I also vaguely heard the sounds of doctors resuscitating me, it seemed like they were using a defibrillator."

Yan Lin pondered for a moment, connecting all the events.

She told Feng Yue, "Do you remember the gifts I gave you on Valentine's Day? The golden nanmu prayer beads and a peace talisman."

Feng Yue nodded.

"The golden nanmu prayer beads broke directly when you collapsed in the park, and many cracks appeared on the beads. They probably preserved your last breath, giving me a chance to get you to the hospital.

Once at the hospital, you went directly into the emergency room. During your resuscitation, the peace talisman behind your phone case turned to ash. The force that pulled you away was probably the peace talisman."

Feng Yue opened her mouth wide in disbelief, looking stunned. "This... this is too mystical!"

Yan Lin nodded in agreement with what Feng Yue said. "Not only that, the day before you woke up, my mother and I went to Jintai Temple and met Master Huiji, who had blessed the prayer beads and drawn the peace talisman. That night, I used your birth date and time to light a lotus lamp praying for peace at Jintai Temple, and you woke up the next day.

I thought it might just be a coincidence at the time, but hearing you talk about what happened in that place, it was probably those things from Jintai Temple that saved your life."

Listening, Feng Yue also fell into thought. After a moment, she shook her head and smiled, "The gods and Buddhas enshrined at Jintai Temple probably also belong to our world. When you awakened the world's consciousness and expelled the controller, you also awakened them, so they probably saved me. So ultimately, you still saved me."

Yan Lin didn't refute Feng Yue's statement. After all, these were all speculations, and she was happy for Feng Yue to credit her with these achievements.

"Hmm, I should really thank you properly, my lifesaver." Feng Yue smiled mischievously. "I think besides treating you to a meal, I should also give you some gift."

"No need." Yan Lin smiled and reached out to take Feng Yue's hand. "As long as you're well, that's the greatest gift for me."

A wave of heat rose on Feng Yue's face. Fortunately, it was getting dark and couldn't be seen clearly. She coughed lightly, withdrew her hand, and muttered, "Cough, we're not in the hospital anymore. With our relationship, all this pulling and tugging isn't appropriate either."

Yan Lin was stunned, but her mind raced and she instantly understood the key point.

"I understand!" After saying this, she looked at Feng Yue with determination and nodded.

Feng Yue: "?" She looked confused. Understood what? She didn't understand herself.

But Yan Lin didn't plan to say more. Just then, the banquet hall called asking them to come back. Yan Lin slowly pushed Feng Yue back.

Until late at night, the Feng family, as hosts, saw off tonight's guests one by one, until only the Yan family remained.

The parents of both families chatted in front while Yan Lin pushed Feng Yue walking behind. Feng Yue could clearly sense Yan Lin's low mood.

She thought seriously - tonight was probably the first time since her coma that they would sleep in their own homes separately. Usually, Yan Lin had been accompanying her in the hospital room.

But now that Feng Yue had been discharged and returned home, Yan Lin couldn't possibly go to Feng Yue's house to take care of her. Their status alone would be very inappropriate.

Feng Yue accepted Yan Lin's resentful glances, watching her look at herself expectantly like a big dog. An inexplicable sense of amusement rose in Feng Yue's heart.

However, Feng Yue didn't specifically speak to her, but after politely saying goodbye to Yan Lin's parents, she quietly said to Yan Lin, "You should have brought home the gift I gave you from the hospital, right? Rest well, good night."

"..." Yan Lin silently looked at her and said in a muffled voice, "Good night."

Until the Yan family's car started, Yan Lin looked longingly and reluctantly at Feng Yue outside through the rear window glass, watching her figure gradually shrink until it disappeared.

Seeing her like this, Jiang Shu Yu teased without hiding it, "Ah Lin, I think you're like a child who hasn't been weaned, so reluctant to part?"

"Mm, very reluctant." Yan Lin showed no embarrassment on her face, instead continuing seriously, "I don't even want to be separated from her for a minute or a second."

So she needed to quickly make sleeping together with Ah Yue legal and reasonable.

Author's Note:

ps Regarding the extras, I'm currently planning two extras: one about President Yan's three years of agonizing life after Ah Yue's death, and another tentatively about their wedding. Is there anything else you'd like to see? This story doesn't have children - even if there were little ones, I wouldn't make Ah Yue give birth, so if you want to see little ones, they'd probably be adopted babies. If you want to see extras for other supporting characters, please let me know who.

I know the most requested would definitely be our Sister Wen. If I write about Sister Wen, it should be a solo beauty extra, because if paired with Little Fu, it would probably be forced love (shivering)

Footnotes:

¹ "Offer a carrot after the stick" (打一棒给一个甜枣) - A Chinese idiom meaning to give someone a reward or treat after being harsh or demanding, similar to "carrot and stick" approach.